THE PRICE OF DAWN — MONSTER & CREATURE COMPENDIUM

Master Table Combat Quick Reference · D&D 5e Stat Blocks · HP Trackers · GM Directives

MASTER COMBAT QUICK-REFERENCE & INITIATIVE TRACKER

CREATURE / ROLE	CR	AC	HP (FORMULA)	SPEED	SENSES	KEY SAVES	TACTICAL PRIORITY & THREAT
Commander Harran Lecht LORD COMMANDER OF THE RECKONING · TRAGIC FANATIC	CR 6	17	102 (12d8 + 48)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 13	Str +7, Con +7, Wis +3	Charges directly for the center dais. Knocks party defenders away with Shield Slam so his soldiers can disrupt...
Lieutenant Senna Kard FIELD COMMANDER · SECOND-IN-COMMAND (CONFLICTED)	CR 5	16	78 (12d8 + 24)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 14	Dex +5, Wis +4	Stays 20 ft behind the vanguard, ordering soldiers to disarm and drag Dawnborn rather than slaughter. Fights d...
Reckoning Veteran VARENHOLD GARRISON INFANTRY · SHIELD WALL	CR 3	17	58 (9d8 + 18)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 12	None	Advance in pairs or wedges behind heavy shields. Prioritize shoving Dawnborn off Primer Stones over killing PC...
Solennite Blade Infiltrator KESEPH VYNE'S GUILD MERCENARY · SABOTEUR	CR 2	15	44 (8d8 + 8)	35 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 12	Dex +5	Use Cunning Action to skirt around the frontline and reach the central dais. Focus attacks on damaging Corven'...
Grasping Tendril THE FLOWERING'S FAILED EXPERIMENT · FLESH HORROR	CR 6	14	91 (14d8 + 28)	35 ft., climb 20 ft.	Blindsight 30 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10	Str +7, Con +5	Ignores heavy armor tanks unless physically blocked. Unfolds rubbery limbs to grapple Ixa from 10 ft away. Onc...
Null-Warden ELITE CONCORDANCE INVERSION ENFORCER	CR 11	19	161 (19d8 + 76)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17	Str +9, Con +8, Wis +7	Locks down the party's primary spellcaster with Null Aura. Repositions using Shadow Step. Drops Sever Resonanc...
Priest of the Inward Crescent SHADAR-KAI RITUALIST · DOCTRINE ZEALOT	CR 7	14	97 (15d8 + 30)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17	Int +6, Wis +7	Priests stay adjacent to complete the suppression ritual. One maintains Spirit Guardians around the plinth, th...
Unlit Shadow-Keeper CELL COMMANDER · TACTICAL COMMANDER	CR 8	17	112 (15d8 + 45)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 16	Str +6, Con +6, Wis +6	Opens with Enveloping Dark. Shadow Steps to flank party frontliners and uses Cell Command to trigger Operative...
Unlit Doctrinal Voice THEOLOGICAL OFFICER · BACKLINE CONTROLLER	CR 7	13	84 (13d8 + 26)	30 ft.	Passive Perception 13	Int +7, Wis +6	Stays at maximum range. Opens with Hold Person or Hypnotic Pattern. Signals Operatives to coup-de-grace paraly...
Unlit Operative SHADAR-KAI INFILTRATOR · CELL SOLDIER	CR 5	15	65 (10d8 + 20)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15	Dex +7, Wis +5	Open with crossbows, Shadow Step into melee when an ally flanks. Switch to cover below 15 HP. If the Shadow-Ke...
Dusk Priest CONCORDANCE ORDAINED LEADER · TANNERY ENCOUNTER	CR 7	14	110 (17d8 + 34)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17	Wis +7, Cha +5	Commands The Returned to pin down frontliners. Uses Spirit Guardians and Toll the Dead. Signals tactical retre...
The Returned (Concordance Ghast) BRANDED INITIATE UNDEAD · PARALYZING CLAWS	CR 3	13	65 (10d8 + 20)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 12	Con +4	Swarm adjacent to each other for Pack Tactics. Focus claws on high-AC warriors to inflict paralysis, then bite...
Cinder-of-Ashfall TABAXI RECKONING SCOUT · PRAGMATIC INFILTRATOR	CR 3	14	52 (8d8 + 16)	30 ft., climb 20 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15	Dex +6, Int +3	Stays mobile along rooftops and rafters. Fights to disable, not slaughter. Retreats or negotiates below 15 HP....
The Vault-Warden TOLVIN HEUSCHEL'S BOUND SPIRIT · BRIDGE GUARDIAN	CR 5	16	85 (10d10 + 30)	30 ft.	Darkvision 60 ft., Tremorsense 30 ft. (bridge only), Passive Perception 16	Str +8, Con +6	Guards the chasm bridge. Punishes players who try to sprint past. Ceases hostility if Ixa speaks to it....

SESSION 5: THE CLIMAX PLAZA

Goal: Stop Harran Lecht's vanguard from breaking Corven's ritual while preventing the Tendril from dragging Ixa into the sunken conduits.

Ritual Clock: 4 complete rounds of concentration (DC 10 Con check if damaged). A DC 15 Persuasion check causes Senna Kard to order a ceasefire on Round 4.

SESSION 4: THE CONCORDANCE CORE

Goal: Infiltrate the subterranean inversion chamber, neutralize the Null-Warden and Inward Crescent ritualists, and retrieve the Prime Core.

Null Field: Spellcasters within 10 ft of the Null-Warden must succeed on DC 15 Con checks to cast spells of 1st level or higher.

EARLIER: SHADOWS OF VARENHOLD

Goal: Survive the Tannery ambush by Dusk Priests and Ghasts, negotiate with Cinder-of-Ashfall, and bypass the ancient Vault-Warden.

Chasm Bridge: The Vault-Warden can be reasoned with (DC 13 Persuasion) if Ixa is present or by speaking the Elder Futhark password.

SECTION 1: THE CLIMAX & SESSION 5 ENCOUNTERS — HIGH COMMAND

COMMANDER HARRAN LECHT

LORD COMMANDER OF THE RECKONING · TRAGIC FANATIC

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 17 (scarred half-plate)

Hit Points: **102** (12d8 + 48)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -2
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws: Str +7, Con +7, Wis +3
Skills: Athletics +7, Intimidation +6, Perception +3
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Passive Perception 13
Languages: Common
Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Desperate Conviction. While below 50 HP (bloodied), Harran gains a +2 bonus to all attack rolls and deals an additional 4 (1d8) damage with his broadsword. His armor is battered and his breath is ragged, but he refuses to stop.

Iron Command. Allied soldiers within 30 ft of Harran add +1d4 to their attack rolls and cannot be charmed or frightened while Harran is conscious.

The Unforgiving Choice. Harran cannot be persuaded to abandon his attack with words alone; only reducing him to 0 HP or completing the stone circle before his eyes will break his conviction.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Harran makes three attacks: two with his Heavy Broadsword and one with his Shield Slam.

Heavy Broadsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit (+9 if bloodied), reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage, plus 4 (1d8) slashing damage if bloodied. A brutal, two-handed military cleave driven by desperation.

Shield Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 8 (1d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage. Target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone and pushed 5 ft back.

BONUS ACTIONS

Rally the Lost (Recharge 5–6). As a bonus action, Harran roars a battle cry: 'Hold the line! For Varenhold!' Up to four allied soldiers within 30 ft immediately gain 15 temporary hit points and can move up to their speed toward the dais without provoking opportunity attacks.

REACTIONS

Unyielding Parry. Harran adds +3 to his AC against one melee attack that would hit him. To do so, he must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

GM Tactics & Morale: Charges directly for the center dais. Knocks party defenders away with Shield Slam so his soldiers can disrupt the Dawnborn. At bloodied (under 50 HP), he ignores opportunity attacks to reach whoever holds Corven's box. When reduced to 0 HP, he collapses to his knees; if the circle is glowing gold, his will breaks in awe.

LIEUTENANT SENNA KARD

FIELD COMMANDER · SECOND-IN-COMMAND (CONFLICTED)

Medium humanoid (human), neutral good (conflicted)

Armor Class: 16 (studded leather + buckler)

Hit Points: **78** (12d8 + 24)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -8
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws: Dex +5, Wis +4
Skills: Insight +5, Perception +4, Persuasion +4
Senses: Passive Perception 14
Languages: Common
Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Hesitant Blade. Senna does not want to slaughter civilians or Dawnborn. She fights defensively. If a PC uses their action to speak to her about the cost of the fight or her fear of meaningless bloodshed, she has disadvantage on attack rolls until the start of her next turn.

Protective Discipline. Allied soldiers within 15 ft of Senna gain a +1 bonus to AC and saving throws.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Senna makes three Officer's Sabre attacks.

Officer's Sabre. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage. If targeting a Dawnborn, Senna always chooses non-lethal damage.

Order: Stand Down (1/Battle). Triggered by a successful DC 15 Persuasion check addressing her conscience. Senna lowers her blade and shouts: 'Hold your steel! We are not butchers!' All remaining Veterans take the Dodge action and cease attacking.

BONUS ACTIONS

Rally the Guard (Recharge 5–6). Senna shouts tactical orders. Up to three allied soldiers within 30 ft gain 10 temporary hit points and can move up to 15 ft without provoking opportunity attacks.

REACTIONS

Parry. Senna adds +3 to her AC against one melee attack that would hit her.

GM Tactics & Morale: Stays 20 ft behind the vanguard, ordering soldiers to disarm and drag Dawnborn rather than slaughter. Fights defensively. If targeted by emotional appeals or confronted with civilian casualties, she can be persuaded to order a ceasefire (DC 15 Persuasion).

SECTION 1: THE CLIMAX & SESSION 5 ENCOUNTERS — BATTLEFIELD & VANGUARD

RECKONING VETERAN

VARENHOLD GARRISON INFANTRY · SHIELD WALL

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 17 (splint mail)

Hit Points: **58** (9d8 + 18)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -8`

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills: Athletics +5, Perception +2
Senses: Passive Perception 12
Languages: Common
Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Shield Wall. The Veteran gains a +1 bonus to AC (included) for each allied soldier wielding a shield within 5 ft (maximum +2).

Disciplined Advance. The Veteran has advantage on saving throws against being knocked prone or moved against their will while adjacent to an ally.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Veteran makes two Longsword attacks or two Heavy Crossbow attacks.

Longsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing damage, or 9 (1d10 + 4) if two-handed. A heavy, drilled military chop.

Heavy Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +3 to hit, range 100/400 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d10 + 1) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Disrupt the Circle. When adjacent to a Dawnborn or ritual participant, the Veteran attempts an Athletics check (contested by target's Str/Dex save, DC 13) to drag or shove that person up to 10 ft away from their stone.

REACTIONS

Interpose Shield. When an adjacent ally is targeted by an attack, the Veteran imposes disadvantage on the attack roll.

GM Tactics & Morale: Advance in pairs or wedges behind heavy shields. Prioritize shoving Dawnborn off Primer Stones over killing PCs. If Senna calls a halt or half their number falls, the rest must make DC 13 Wis saves or retreat.

SOLENNITE BLADE INFILTRATOR

KESEPH VYNE'S GUILD MERCENARY · SABOTEUR

Medium humanoid (half-elf), neutral evil

Armor Class: 15 (studded leather)

Hit Points: **44** (8d8 + 8)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5 ☐ -5`

Speed: 35 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws: Dex +5
Skills: Acrobatics +5, Stealth +7, Sleight of Hand +5
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 12
Languages: Common, Elvish
Challenge: 2 (450 XP)

Saboteur's Precision. Weapon attacks deal an extra 7 (2d6) damage against inanimate ritual objects, stone conduits, and puzzle housings.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn). Deals an extra 7 (2d6) damage to a creature it hits with a weapon attack if it has advantage on the attack roll or an ally is within 5 ft.

ACTIONS

Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage + 3 (1d6) poison damage.

Hand Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Cunning Action. The Blade can take the Dash, Disengage, or Hide action as a bonus action on each of its turns.

REACTIONS

Shadow Slip. When targeted by a melee attack, the Blade can use its reaction to impose disadvantage on the roll by darting into a nearby shadow.

GM Tactics & Morale: Use Cunning Action to skirt around the frontline and reach the central dais. Focus attacks on damaging Corven's Concordance Stone or snatching an unseated cube. If cornered or reduced below 15 HP, they flee into the crowd.

GRASPING TENDRIL

THE FLOWERING'S FAILED EXPERIMENT · FLESH HORROR

Medium aberration (formerly humanoid), unaligned

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: **91** (14d8 + 28)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -1`

Speed: 35 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)	10 (+0)	4 (-3)

Saving Throws: Str +7, Con +5
Skills: Athletics +7, Stealth +6
Damage Resistances: Bludgeoning, piercing, slashing from nonmagical attacks
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Blindsight 30 ft., Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak
Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP)

Target Lock (Ixa). The Tendril is hardwired to retrieve Ixa. It cannot be taunted or charmed away from her. If Ixa breaks line of sight, it spends its full movement each turn to reacquire her.

Flexible Form. Can squeeze through spaces as tight as 1 ft wide without penalty. Opportunity attacks against it while squeezing have disadvantage.

Pack Retrieval. When two or more Tendrils are within 5 ft of the same grappled target, both have advantage on Athletics checks to maintain or move the grapple.

Not Dead. At 0 HP, the Tendril does not die—it collapses, paralyzed but conscious. A DC 14 Medicine check reveals it was once a human citizen, altered to the bone by surgical horror, and that the person inside is still watching.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Tendril makes two Grasping Slam attacks, or one Grasping Slam and one Constrict.

Grasping Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage. If target is Large or smaller, it is grappled (escape DC 16). Can grapple up to two creatures at once.

Constrict. Target must already be grappled. Hit: 13 (2d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage and must succeed on DC 15 Str save or be restrained until grapple ends.

GM Tactics & Morale: Ignores heavy armor tanks unless physically blocked. Unfolds rubbery limbs to grapple Ixa from 10 ft away. Once Ixa is grappled, moves at half speed toward the plaza perimeter to abduct her. Secondary objective: do not let them carry Ixa past the boundary!

COMBAT FLOW & TACTICAL DIRECTIVES: THE CLIMAX PLAZA

Wave 1 (The Tendril Ambush): As the ritual begins, Grasping Tendrils erupt from sunken stone vents. Their hardwired target is Ixa (carrying the Prime Core). Tendrils attempt to grapple and drag her 10 ft/round toward the perimeter.

Wave 2 (The Reckoning Vanguard): On Round 3, Commander Harran Lecht and Lieutenant Senna Kard charge the dais with 4 Reckoning Veterans and 2 Solennite Blades. Veterans advance in a shield wall to pin frontliners.

Dynamic Battlefield & Win Conditions:

- *Ritual Activation:* Corven must maintain concentration for 4 full rounds to stabilize the Dawn Core.
- *The Moral Pivot:* A DC 15 Persuasion check targeting Senna Kard causes her to lower her blade. If shown civilian casualties or Corven's defensive stance, she orders a ceasefire on Round 4.
- *Harran's Last Stand:* Harran cannot be persuaded while conscious. When reduced to 0 HP, he collapses to his knees; seeing the golden light awaken the stone circle breaks his fanatic conviction.

SECTION 2: THE CONCORDANCE & SESSION 4 FOES — THE INVERSION RITUALISTS

NULL-WARDEN

ELITE CONCORDANCE INVERSION ENFORCER

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 19 (obsidian-etched plate armor)

Hit Points: **161** (19d8 + 76)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -1
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Str +9, Con +8, Wis +7
Skills: Arcana +7, Athletics +9, Perception +7
Damage Resistances: Necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, slashing from nonmagical attacks
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon
Challenge: 11 (7,200 XP)

Null Aura. Creatures within 10 ft of the Warden cannot cast spells of 1st level or higher without succeeding on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw. On failure, the spell slot is expended and the spell fails.

Magical Resistance. The Null-Warden has advantage on saving throws against spells and magical effects.

Inversion Anchor. When standing on or within 10 ft of a ritual plinth, the Warden is immune to forced movement and cannot be knocked prone.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Warden makes three attacks with its Null Rod.

Null Rod. Melee Weapon Attack: +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 10 (1d10 + 5) bludgeoning damage + 9 (2d8) necrotic damage. If target is concentrating on a spell, the DC to maintain concentration is at least 15.

Sever Resonance (Recharge 5–6). The Warden strikes the stone floor with the rod. A shockwave of null-magic ripples out in a 20-ft radius. All creatures must make a DC 16 Constitution save, taking 28 (8d6) force damage on failure (half on success), and any active magical buff of 3rd level or lower is dispelled.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step (Recharge 4–6). Teleports up to 30 ft between dim or dark spaces. Arrives with advantage on its next melee attack.

REACTIONS

Spellcrusher. When a creature within 5 ft casts a spell, the Warden makes a Null Rod attack against that creature. If it hits, the caster must make a DC 16 Con save or the spell is ruined.

GM Tactics & Morale: Locks down the party's primary spellcaster with Null Aura. Repositions using Shadow Step. Drops Sever Resonance when surrounded. Fights to the death to protect the suppression circle.

PRIEST OF THE INWARD CRESCENT

SHADAR-KAI RITUALIST · DOCTRINE ZEALOT

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 14 (chain shirt)

Hit Points: **97** (15d8 + 30)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -7
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws: Int +6, Wis +7
Skills: Arcana +6, Insight +7, Perception +7, Religion +6
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Condition Immunities: Charmed
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon
Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP)

Suppression Ritual. While two Priests are within 10 ft of each other, they pour obsidian powder to sever the stone's resonance. Breaking concentration requires 20+ damage in a single hit or physically disrupting the powder line.

Doctrinal Certainty. Advantage on saves vs spells that compel truth or alter belief.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Two attacks: Toll the Dead + Spiritual Weapon, or two Inflict Wounds.

Inflict Wounds. Melee Spell Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 22 (4d10) necrotic damage. Skin beneath withers like dry winter ash.

Toll the Dead (Cantrip). One creature within 60 ft: DC 15 Wis save or 9 (2d8) necrotic, or 13 (2d12) if missing any HP.

Spirit Guardians (3rd Slot, Conc). 15-ft aura of necrotic spirits: DC 15 Wis save or take 18 (4d8) necrotic upon entering/starting turn.

Banishment (4th Slot, Conc). DC 15 Cha save or banished to harmless demiplane for 1 minute.

BONUS ACTIONS

Spiritual Weapon. Spawns floating obsidian blade: +7 to hit, 1d8 + 4 force damage. Can attack as bonus action each turn.

Shadow Step (Recharge 5–6). Teleports up to 30 ft between dim/dark spaces.

REACTIONS

Counterspell (3rd Slot). Interrupts a spell of 3rd level or lower within 60 ft.

GM Tactics & Morale: Priests stay adjacent to complete the suppression ritual. One maintains Spirit Guardians around the plinth, the other casts Spiritual Weapon and Toll the Dead. Counterspell party healing.

SECTION 2: THE CONCORDANCE & SESSION 4 FOES — SHADOW CELL COMMAND

UNLIT SHADOW-KEEPER

CELL COMMANDER · TACTICAL COMMANDER

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 17 (chain mail + shield)

Hit Points: 112 (15d8 + 45)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -2
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws: Str +6, Con +6, Wis +6
Skills: Athletics +6, Insight +6, Perception +6, Stealth +6
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 16
Languages: Common, Elvish, Undercommon
Challenge: 8 (3,900 XP)

Cell Command. When the Shadow-Keeper uses Shadow Step, all allied Operatives within 30 ft may use their reaction to make one weapon attack.

Twilight Awareness. Cannot be surprised in dim light or darkness. Perceives invisible creatures within 15 ft as blurred silhouettes (DC 14 to pinpoint).

Doctrine Hold. Immune to spells that read thoughts or compel truth.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Three Shortsword attacks or two Shortsword + one Shadow Drain.

Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing + 7 (2d6) necrotic.

Shadow Drain. Ranged Spell Attack: +6 to hit, range 60 ft. Hit: 14 (4d6) necrotic damage and target's speed is halved until end of next turn.

Enveloping Dark (Recharge 5–6). 15-ft radius: dim light becomes darkness for 1 minute (concentration). Non-shadar-kai must make DC 14 Con save or be blinded until leaving the area.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step (Recharge 4–6). Teleports up to 30 ft between dim/dark spaces. Advantage on next melee attack.

REACTIONS

Interpose Shadow. When an ally within 10 ft is hit, the Shadow-Keeper takes half the damage instead (split equally).

GM Tactics & Morale: Opens with Enveloping Dark. Shadow Steps to flank party frontliners and uses Cell Command to trigger Operative reaction attacks. Fights until 0 HP.

UNLIT DOCTRINAL VOICE

THEOLOGICAL OFFICER · BACKLINE CONTROLLER

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 13 (mage armor)

Hit Points: 84 (13d8 + 26)

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HP Tracking: □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -10 □ -4
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Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Int +7, Wis +6
Skills: Arcana +7, History +7, Insight +6, Persuasion +5
Condition Immunities: Charmed
Senses: Passive Perception 13
Languages: Common, Elvish, Dwarvish, Infernal
Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP)

Doctrinal Certainty (3/Day). Legendary Resistance against spells attempting to alter beliefs, charm, or compel action.

Back Line. Never voluntarily moves within 30 ft of a player character.

ACTIONS

Toll the Dead. Range 60 ft: DC 15 Wis save or 9 (2d8) necrotic, or 13 (2d12) if damaged.

Hold Person (2nd Slot). Humanoid within 60 ft: DC 15 Wis save or paralyzed for 1 min (concentration).

Hypnotic Pattern (3rd Slot). 30-ft cube within 120 ft: DC 15 Wis save or incapacitated (speed 0) until damaged.

Fear (3rd Slot). 30-ft cone: DC 15 Wis save or frightened and dashes away.

Banishment (4th Slot). DC 15 Cha save or banished 1 min.

Greater Invisibility (4th Slot). Becomes invisible for 1 min (concentration).

BONUS ACTIONS

Misty Step (2nd Slot). Teleports up to 30 ft as bonus action.

REACTIONS

Counterspell (3rd Slot). Negates a spell within 60 ft. Prioritizes countering healing or dispel magic.

Shield (1st Slot). +5 to AC until start of next turn, blocks Magic Missile.

GM Tactics & Morale: Stays at maximum range. Opens with Hold Person or Hypnotic Pattern. Signals Operatives to coup-de-grace paralyzed PCs. Casts Greater Invisibility at 50% HP.

SECTION 2: THE CONCORDANCE & SESSION 4 FOES — OPERATIVES & CHAMBER HAZARDS

UNLIT OPERATIVE

SHADAR-KAI INFILTRATOR · CELL SOLDIER

Medium humanoid (shadar-kai), lawful neutral

Armor Class: 15 (studded leather)

Hit Points: 65 (10d8 + 20)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -5`

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Dex +7, Wis +5
Skills: Athletics +4, Deception +3, Perception +5, Stealth +9
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Condition Immunities: Charmed, frightened
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages: Common, Elvish
Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Pack Tactics. Advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one ally is within 5 ft of the creature.

Cell Discipline. Cannot reveal names or locations above their cell—they have been mind-blanked.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Two Shortsword attacks or two Hand Crossbow attacks.

Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage.

Hand Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, range 30/120 ft. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step (Recharge 4–6). Teleports up to 30 ft between dim/dark spaces. Advantage on next melee attack.

REACTIONS

Fade. When reduced to 0 HP, makes one final reflexive Shadow Step to nearby cover before falling unconscious, leaving no trail.

GM Tactics & Morale: Open with crossbows, Shadow Step into melee when an ally flanks. Switch to cover below 15 HP. If the Shadow-Keeper falls, make one final reckless attack with advantage before withdrawing.

THE CONCORDANCE CHAMBER: LAIR ACTIONS & HAZARDS

Lair Actions (Initiative Count 20, loses ties):

- *Null Inversion Pulse:* Obsidian conduits hum with negative energy. Each non-shadar-kai creature within 60 ft must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw or have its magical healing halved and suffer disadvantage on concentration checks until the next initiative count 20.
- *Shadow Gloom:* Dim light throughout the chamber deepens into magical darkness in a 20-ft radius sphere centered on a point the Null-Warden chooses. Creatures without Devil's Sight or Blindsight cannot see through it.
- *Resonance Flare:* The plinth releases an amber-and-grey shockwave. Creatures within 15 ft of the central dais take 10 (3d6) force damage (DC 14 Dex save for half) and are pushed 10 ft away.

Tactical Cell Directives:

- *Operative Swarm:* Operatives never engage alone; they exploit *Pack Tactics* alongside Shadow-Keepers. If a spellcaster casts a spell, Operatives trigger reaction attacks to break concentration.
- *Retreat Trigger:* If the Null-Warden falls or 3 cell members are killed, remaining Operatives trigger *Fade* and melt into the deep stone vents.

SECTION 3: SHADOWS OF VARENHOLD — THE TANNERY ENCOUNTER

DUSK PRIEST

CONCORDANCE ORDAINED LEADER · TANNERY ENCOUNTER

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil

Armor Class: 14 (studded leather)

Hit Points: **110** (17d8 + 34)

HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Wis +7, Cha +5
Skills: Perception +7, Religion +5, Stealth +5
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 17
Languages: Common, Elvish
Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP)

Twilight Authority. Undead allies within 30 ft have advantage on saving throws against being turned.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Cast Toll the Dead + one Dagger attack, or cast two spells.

Sacrificial Dagger. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing + 10 (3d6) necrotic.

Toll the Dead. Range 60 ft: DC 15 Wis save or 9 (2d8) necrotic, or 13 (2d12) if damaged.

Spirit Guardians. DC 15 Wis save or 18 (4d8) necrotic aura.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shadow Step. Teleports up to 30 ft between dim or dark spaces.

REACTIONS

Shield of the Dark. When hit by an attack, gains +3 AC until end of turn.

GM Tactics & Morale: Commands The Returned to pin down frontliners. Uses Spirit Guardians and Toll the Dead. Signals tactical retreat with sealed-door brand gesture if reduced below 30 HP.

THE RETURNED (CONCORDANCE GHAST)

BRANDED INITIATE UNDEAD · PARALYZING CLAWS

Medium undead, chaotic evil

Armor Class: 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points: **65** (10d8 + 20)

HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -5

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)

Saving Throws: Con +4
Skills: Perception +2
Damage Resistances: Necrotic
Damage Immunities: Poison
Condition Immunities: Charmed, exhaustion, poisoned, paralyzed
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 12
Languages: Understands Common but cannot speak
Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Stench. Creatures starting turn within 5 ft must make DC 13 Con save or be poisoned until start of next turn. Success grants 24h immunity.

Pack Tactics. Advantage on attack rolls when an ally is within 5 ft of target.

Turning Defiance. Advantage on saving throws against effects that turn undead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. One Bite and one Claws attack.

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 10 (2d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Claws. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 8 (2d4 + 3) slashing damage. If target is non-undead, must succeed on DC 13 Con save or be paralyzed until end of next turn.

GM Tactics & Morale: Swarm adjacent to each other for Pack Tactics. Focus claws on high-AC warriors to inflict paralysis, then bite paralyzed targets with automatic criticals.

THE SUNKEN TANNERY: HAZARDS & TACTICAL NOTES

Atmospheric Hazards:

• *Acid Vats:* Three massive stone vats contain caustic tannery runoff. A creature shoved or falling into a vat takes 14 (4d6) acid damage at the start of its turn. Climbing out requires 10 ft of movement and a DC 12 Athletics check.
• *Slick Flagstones:* The floor is coated in grease and slime. Any creature moving more than half speed must succeed on a DC 11 Dexterity saving throw or fall prone.

Encounter Tactics:

• The Dusk Priest uses *Spirit Guardians* to create a lethal 15-ft killzone while The Returned flank around the acid vats, attempting to paralyze frontliners with their claws.
• The Dusk Priest prioritizes casting *Toll the Dead* on paralyzed targets for guaranteed maximum critical damage.

SECTION 3: SHADOWS OF VARENHOLD — INFILTRATOR & THE ANCIENT BRIDGE

CINDER-OF-ASHFALL

TABAXI RECKONING SCOUT · PRAGMATIC INFILTRATOR

Medium humanoid (tabaxi), neutral

Armor Class: 14 (leather armor)

Hit Points: 52 (8d8 + 16)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -2`

Speed: 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Dex +6, Int +3
Skills: Acrobatics +6, Perception +5, Stealth +8
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages: Common, Thieves' Cant
Challenge: 3 (700 XP)

Feline Agility. Doubles speed until end of turn. Recharges when she moves 0 ft on a turn.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn). Deals extra 10 (3d6) damage to a target she hits with a finesse or ranged weapon with advantage.

Evasion. Dex save success = 0 damage, failure = half damage.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Two Shortsword attacks or two Hand Crossbow attacks.

Shortsword. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage.

Hand Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, range 30/120 ft. Hit: 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Cunning Action. Dash, Disengage, or Hide as bonus action.

REACTIONS

Uncanny Dodge. Halves damage from one attack she can see.

GM Tactics & Morale: Stays mobile along rooftops and rafters. Fights to disable, not slaughter. Retreats or negotiates below 15 HP.

THE VAULT-WARDEN

TOLVIN HEUSCHEL'S BOUND SPIRIT · BRIDGE GUARDIAN

Large construct (bound spirit), neutral

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 85 (10d10 + 30)

`HP Tracking: ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -10 ☐ -5`

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	8 (-1)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Str +8, Con +6
Skills: Athletics +8, Perception +6
Damage Resistances: Bludgeoning, piercing, slashing from nonmagical attacks
Damage Immunities: Poison, psychic
Condition Immunities: Charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft., Tremorsense 30 ft. (bridge only), Passive Perception 16
Languages: Common (archaic), Elder Futhark
Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP)

Bridge Lock. While on the bridge, immune to forced movement and cannot be knocked prone.

Imperfect Memory. Can be reasoned with (DC 13 Persuasion, or DC 10 if Ixa is present). If convinced the party seeks to stop the ritual, stands aside willingly.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Two Crushing Blow attacks.

Crushing Blow. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 10 ft. Hit: 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning. DC 15 Str save or knocked prone and pushed 5 ft.

Warden's Pulse (Recharge 5–6). 30-ft burst of amber-grey light: DC 14 Con save or 14 (4d6) radiant damage and knocked prone.

REACTIONS

Threshold Challenge. When a creature crosses the bridge midpoint, makes one Crushing Blow reaction and stops their movement.

GM Tactics & Morale: Guards the chasm bridge. Punishes players who try to sprint past. Ceases hostility if Ixa speaks to it.

TOLVIN HEUSCHEL'S BRIDGE: CHASM HAZARDS & RP HOOKS

The Chasm Bridge (Bridge of the Pale Watch):

• *Precarious Crossing:* The narrow archway is 80 ft long, 10 ft wide, without railings. A 60-ft plunge into the jagged aqueduct deals 21 (6d6) bludgeoning damage.

• *Warden's Challenge:* The Vault-Warden blocks the midpoint. It cannot leave the bridge (Bridge Lock). If the party approaches peacefully, it speaks in archaic Elder Futhark: *'Who approaches the resting stone of the Sun?'*

• *Social Resolution:* If Ixa is present or a PC succeeds on a DC 13 Persuasion check citing the restoration of the light, the Warden deactivates and steps aside.

Cinder-of-Ashfall Roleplay & Bargain:

• Cinder is a pragmatic tabaxi rogue hired by Keseph Vyne's network. She has no loyalty to fanaticism and surrenders if reduced to 15 HP.

• In exchange for safe passage out of the city, she provides secret maps of the subterranean duct system leading directly under the Concordance dais.